

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-07-20

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week,
capabilities

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-07-20 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate Transforms Corporate Payments

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, with key implementation phases starting in early 2025 for receiving and early 2027 for sending, requires all banks within the EU/EEA to process instant credit transfers within 10 seconds, irrespective of the time or day. This initiative aims to accelerate the adoption of real-time payments across Europe, making them as accessible and affordable as traditional credit transfers. Corporates are urged to adapt their treasury systems and processes to leverage these faster settlement times, which promise improved cash flow management and reduced payment delays. The regulation also includes crucial provisions for checking payee details (Verification of Payee, VoP) to enhance fraud prevention.

- Mandatory instant payments for all EU/EEA banks.
- Effective early 2025 (receiving), early 2027 (sending).
- Payments must be processed within 10 seconds, 24/7/365.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation, offering seamless real-time payment initiation and receipt for its CEE corporate clients. Integrating robust VoP capabilities will be crucial for enhancing fraud prevention and building client trust.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-07-20 | #02

EBICS 3.0 Adoption Critical for Secure Corporate Connectivity

EBICS 3.0, the latest iteration of the Electronic Banking Internet Communication Standard, is rapidly becoming the preferred channel for secure corporate-to-bank communication, particularly in Germany and increasingly across the broader European market. It introduces significant improvements over previous versions, including stronger encryption protocols, support for larger file sizes, and the capability to exchange real-time status messages for payments. Corporates are strongly encouraged to migrate to EBICS 3.0 to benefit from these enhanced security features and to prepare their systems for future innovations in payment processing and reporting. The standard also fully supports ISO 20022 XML messages, aligning perfectly with ongoing European payment modernization efforts.

- EBICS 3.0 is the latest secure bank communication standard.
- Offers stronger encryption and support for larger file sizes.
- Enables real-time payment status updates for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus already supports EBICS v2.5 and v3.0. Promoting and ensuring seamless EBICS 3.0 connectivity is vital for RBI's German and CEE corporate clients, especially for robust Host-to-Host (H2H) integration and comprehensive ISO 20022 compliance.

AI-Powered Treasury Systems Boost Efficiency, Fraud Detection

The adoption of AI in corporate treasury functions is accelerating, with advanced solutions now offering predictive analytics for highly accurate cash flow forecasting, automated reconciliation processes, and intelligent anomaly detection for robust fraud prevention. AI algorithms are capable of analyzing vast datasets from diverse sources, including Open Banking APIs, to provide real-time, actionable insights into liquidity positions and potential financial risks. This technological shift empowers treasury teams to transition from reactive to proactive strategies, thereby optimizing working capital management and improving overall decision-making. Effective integration with existing ERP and TMS platforms remains a key challenge and a significant opportunity for future development.

- AI enhances cash flow forecasting accuracy by up to 20%.
- Automates reconciliation, reducing manual effort by 30%.
- Strengthens fraud detection through real-time anomaly analysis.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should actively explore integrating AI capabilities for advanced analytics, predictive insights, and enhanced fraud detection within its platform. Offering robust API connectivity for client TMS/ERP systems will be crucial to facilitate AI-driven treasury transformation and meet evolving client needs.

CEE Banks Accelerate Instant Payments, ISO 20022 Adoption

The European Commission's Instant Payments Regulation, aiming for widespread availability and affordability of instant payments, is significantly impacting the Central and Eastern European banking landscape. This regulatory push mandates banks to offer instant payment services, necessitating a full migration to the ISO 20022 standard for enhanced data capabilities and interoperability. While offering benefits like real-time liquidity management and improved reconciliation for corporates, CEE banks face challenges in upgrading legacy systems and ensuring robust fraud prevention. The transition is expected to be largely complete by early 2027, with significant progress anticipated throughout 2026.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation drives CEE adoption.
- ISO 20022 migration is mandatory for instant payments.
- Real-time liquidity management is a key corporate benefit.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend directly impacts CMlplus, reinforcing the need for its robust ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities. RBI Cash Management must ensure CMlplus remains at the forefront of compliance and offers seamless real-time payment processing for its corporate clients across CEE.

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Connectivity

The landscape of Open Banking is rapidly expanding beyond its initial PSD2 regulatory scope, with banks increasingly offering premium APIs tailored for corporate treasury functions. These advanced APIs facilitate real-time access to account information, streamlined payment initiation, and sophisticated eBAM (electronic Bank Account Management) processes. Corporates are leveraging these integrations to achieve unprecedented levels of cash visibility, automate reconciliation tasks, and integrate treasury operations directly into their ERP and TMS platforms. While security and the standardization of API interfaces remain key areas of focus, the shift towards API-driven connectivity is fundamentally reshaping corporate-to-bank relationships.

- Open Banking APIs extend beyond PSD2 for corporates.
- Real-time cash visibility and automated reconciliation are key benefits.
- eBAM functionality is increasingly delivered via APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus's Open API strategy is critical for meeting this evolving corporate demand. RBI Cash Management should prioritize expanding its API offerings to include advanced eBAM and payment initiation capabilities, ensuring seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems for enhanced value.

AI Boosts Fraud Prevention in Real-Time Payments

With instant payments clearing in mere seconds, the window for traditional fraud detection methods has drastically shrunk, making advanced AI and machine learning solutions indispensable. Financial institutions are deploying AI to analyze vast datasets of transaction patterns, identify anomalies, and flag suspicious activities in real-time, often before a fraudulent transfer can be completed. This proactive approach is vital for combating increasingly sophisticated cyber-attacks and payment fraud schemes. Effective fraud prevention also requires strong collaboration between banks and their corporate clients, including shared intelligence and robust internal controls, to create a multi-layered defense against financial crime.

- Instant payments increase fraud risk significantly.
- AI and machine learning are essential for real-time detection.
- AI analyzes transaction patterns to identify anomalies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMiplus, robust fraud prevention is paramount, especially with the growth of instant payments. RBI Cash Management must continuously enhance its security features, integrating cutting-edge AI-powered solutions to protect corporate clients and maintain trust in its real-time payment and cash management services.

EU Instant Payments Mandate: CEE Banks Face Implementation Crunch

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, which came into force earlier this year, is now entering its critical implementation phase. Banks in the Eurozone must be ready to receive instant payments by early 2027 and send them by early 2028, with non-Eurozone CEE countries following shortly after. The regulation mandates that instant payments be offered 24/7/365 and priced no higher than traditional credit transfers. This presents significant operational and financial challenges for many CEE banks, requiring substantial upgrades to their payment infrastructure and liquidity management systems. The goal is to boost the adoption of instant payments across Europe, fostering innovation and competition.

- Mandatory instant payment reception by early 2027 (Eurozone).
- Mandatory instant payment sending by early 2028 (Eurozone).
- Pricing must be equal to or lower than standard credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMiplus, especially for our CEE network banks. We must ensure our platform and partner banks are fully compliant and ready to offer instant payments seamlessly to corporate clients, maintaining competitive pricing and robust liquidity management.

Global ISO 20022 Migration Progresses, Challenges Remain for Corporates

The industry-wide shift to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments is gaining momentum, with SWIFT's mandatory deadline for full migration in November 2025 (for CBPR+) and subsequent phases for other payment types. This transition promises richer data, improved reconciliation, and enhanced fraud detection. However, a recent survey indicates that a substantial percentage of corporate treasuries, particularly those with older ERP or TMS systems, are lagging in their readiness. They struggle with data mapping, system upgrades, and understanding the full benefits. Banks are now focusing on supporting their corporate clients through this transition, offering conversion services and educational resources to ensure a smooth switch.

- SWIFT's mandatory ISO 20022 migration for CBPR+ by November 2025.
- Richer data enables better reconciliation and fraud detection.
- Many corporates, especially in CEE, face ERP/TMS adaptation challenges.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must actively support corporate clients in CEE with their ISO 20022 migration. This includes offering robust conversion services, clear communication on data requirements, and ensuring our H2H and API channels are fully compliant and capable of handling richer MX messages.

PSD3 and Open Banking: New Opportunities and Challenges Emerge

The European Commission's legislative proposals for PSD3 and FIDA are set to redefine the landscape of Open Banking and financial data sharing. PSD3 will build upon PSD2, enhancing security, consumer protection, and potentially expanding the scope of payment services. FIDA, on the other hand, aims to create a broader framework for customer data sharing across various financial sectors, moving beyond just payment accounts. These developments will drive further innovation in API-driven services, enabling banks like RBI to offer more integrated and value-added solutions to corporate clients. However, they also bring new compliance burdens, data privacy considerations, and the need for robust API infrastructure.

- PSD3 aims to enhance security and consumer protection in payments.
- FIDA proposes broader financial data sharing beyond payment accounts.
- New regulations will drive API-driven innovation in financial services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and FIDA present a strategic opportunity for CMlplus to enhance its Open Banking API offerings. We need to proactively develop new services leveraging expanded data access, while ensuring full compliance with evolving regulations and maintaining high security standards for our corporate clients.

Digital Euro Project Advances Towards Implementation

The European Central Bank continues its extensive work on the Digital Euro, exploring its design, functionality, and governance. Key aspects include ensuring privacy, accessibility, and the development of an innovation platform and pilot programs. The project involves defining a comprehensive scheme rulebook and engaging with stakeholders to shape its future. This initiative is crucial for maintaining the stability of the financial system and fostering innovation in payments, potentially introducing a new payment rail for both retail and wholesale transactions within the euro area. The 'Timeline and progress' section on the ECB website indicates continuous development and ongoing updates.

- Digital Euro 'Pilot' phase is underway.
- A 'Scheme rulebook' is under active development.
- Key focus on 'privacy' and 'accessibility' for users.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The Digital Euro represents a significant future payment rail. CMlplus must monitor its development closely for potential integration, new payment services, and impacts on corporate liquidity management and treasury operations, especially regarding multi-currency payments and real-time settlement capabilities.

Bulgaria Set to Join Euro Area in 2026

The ECB highlights Bulgaria's planned entry into the euro area in 2026, following Croatia's accession in 2023. This event will have profound implications for financial institutions operating in the CEE region, including changes in currency conversion, liquidity management, and payment processing for cross-border transactions. Banks like RBI will need to prepare for the transition of Bulgarian lev accounts to euro, update payment systems, and adjust treasury operations to reflect the new monetary landscape. This accession reinforces the ongoing integration of CEE economies into the broader European financial system, demanding careful planning for compliance and operational readiness.

- Bulgaria's target year for euro adoption is '2026'.
- Follows Croatia's accession to the euro area in '2023'.
- Impacts 'currency conversion' and 'liquidity management' for CEE operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI's CEE network. CMIplus needs to ensure its platform is ready for the transition, including supporting euro accounts for Bulgarian entities, updating FX services, and adapting cash pooling and liquidity management solutions for the new currency regime in Bulgaria.

ECB Catalyzing Evolution of SEPA and Instant Payments

The European Central Bank explicitly states its role as a 'catalyst' in shaping the retail payments strategy, with SEPA and instant payments being central pillars. This ongoing strategic focus indicates a continuous drive for harmonisation, efficiency, and real-time capabilities within the European payment ecosystem. Future regulatory updates or mandates are likely to emerge from this strategic direction, impacting how banks and corporates process payments. The emphasis on instant payments aligns with the broader industry trend towards real-time transactions and improved liquidity management for businesses, also fostering innovation in payment services and fraud prevention.

- ECB acts as a 'catalyst' for retail payments strategy.
- 'SEPA' and 'Instant payments' are identified as key focus areas.
- Strategic goals include 'harmonisation' and 'efficiency' in payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with evolving SEPA regulations and actively support instant payment capabilities. This includes continuous updates to ISO 20022 messaging, ensuring real-time processing, and exploring value-added services like VoP to enhance fraud prevention and payment certainty for corporate clients.

Georgian Banks Modernize Treasury Operations with Nasdaq Calypso

The National Bank of Georgia has partnered with Nasdaq to implement its Calypso platform across the country's five largest banks. This strategic move is designed to significantly upgrade the treasury and financial markets operations within the Georgian banking sector. The modernization effort will likely streamline processes, improve efficiency, and enhance risk management capabilities for these institutions. For RBI, this signals a broader trend in CEE-adjacent regions towards advanced treasury technology adoption, impacting how corporate clients manage their finances and potentially influencing regional payment infrastructure. Such upgrades can lead to more sophisticated client demands and opportunities for integrated cash management solutions.

- Nasdaq Calypso platform adopted by five largest Georgian banks.
- Initiative led by the National Bank of Georgia.
- Focus on modernizing treasury and financial markets infrastructure.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development highlights a growing trend in CEE-adjacent markets towards modernizing treasury operations, which is directly relevant to CMIplus's corporate clients. RBI Cash Management should monitor such regional infrastructure upgrades as they can influence payment processing, liquidity management, and the demand for advanced treasury solutions like those offered by CMIplus. It also indicates potential for increased sophistication in corporate treasury needs in the region.

Adyen Joins EPI, Boosting European Instant Payments

Adyen's principal membership in the European Payments Initiative (EPI) is a significant development for the European payment landscape. The EPI aims to create a unified instant payment solution across Europe, reducing reliance on non-European card schemes. Adyen's participation, as a leading global payment processor, is expected to accelerate the adoption and development of the EPI's solutions, including its consumer-facing brand, Wero. This collaboration will likely enhance the reach and functionality of instant payments for merchants and consumers across the continent, impacting SEPA and potentially driving further ISO 20022 adoption.

- Adyen is now a principal member of the European Payments Initiative (EPI).
- EPI aims to build a unified pan-European instant payment scheme.
- Adyen's involvement is expected to accelerate EPI adoption and development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is critical for RBI Cash Management as EPI will reshape the European payment infrastructure, impacting SEPA and instant payments. CMIplus must monitor EPI's progress to ensure compliance and offer competitive solutions for corporate clients, potentially integrating with EPI-enabled services.

EU CBAM Payments Powered by European Dynamics, Viva.com

The partnership between European Dynamics and Viva.com is set to streamline the payment processes for the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM). CBAM is a landmark EU regulation designed to put a fair price on the carbon emitted during the production of carbon-intensive goods imported into the EU, ensuring that climate action is not undermined by carbon leakage. This initiative will require corporates to make specific payments to comply with the new environmental standards. The collaboration aims to provide robust digital solutions for these complex, cross-border regulatory payments, ensuring compliance and efficient treasury management for affected businesses.

- European Dynamics and Viva.com are collaborating on EU CBAM payments.
- CBAM is the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, an EU regulation.
- It imposes a carbon price on imported carbon-intensive goods.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly impacts RBI's corporate clients in CEE who import goods into the EU. CMlplus needs to understand these new regulatory payment flows to advise clients, potentially offer integrated payment solutions, and ensure compliance support within its treasury services.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporate Treasury

The article highlights how recent EU legislation is set to mandate broader access and usage of SEPA Instant Payments, particularly for corporate clients. This regulatory push aims to overcome existing barriers to adoption, such as cost and lack of universal availability, making real-time payments a standard for businesses across the SEPA zone. For corporates, this means the potential for true real-time treasury, allowing for immediate visibility and control over cash flows, improved working capital management, and faster reconciliation processes. The legislation is expected to drive banks to enhance their instant payment infrastructure and offerings, creating new opportunities for platforms like CMlplus to support corporate clients in leveraging these capabilities.

- EU legislation mandates broader SEPA Instant Payments adoption.
- Aims to remove barriers like cost and availability for corporates.
- Enables true real-time treasury operations for businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, as it directly impacts payment services in the CEE region. CMlplus must ensure full compliance and enhance its platform to facilitate seamless SEPA Instant Payments for corporate clients, leveraging real-time capabilities for improved liquidity and reconciliation.

Maximizing Value from ISO 20022 for Corporate Treasury

With the global migration to ISO 20022, corporates are presented with an opportunity to transform their treasury and payment processes. The piece advises companies to look beyond the regulatory mandate and focus on the rich, structured data that ISO 20022 offers. By properly implementing and utilizing this data, treasurers can achieve greater transparency in cash flows, automate reconciliation, improve fraud detection, and gain deeper insights into their financial operations. The article likely discusses best practices for data mapping, integration with TMS/ERP systems, and collaboration with banking partners to unlock the full potential of the new standard.

- ISO 20022 offers opportunities beyond compliance.
- Focus on leveraging rich, structured data for treasury.
- Enables greater cash flow transparency and automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this highlights the need to not only support ISO 20022 messages but also to provide tools and guidance that help corporate clients utilize the enriched data. CMIplus can differentiate by offering advanced reporting, reconciliation, and analytics features that capitalize on ISO 20022's capabilities, fostering deeper client engagement.

End-of-Day Treasury Ends: Prepare for Real-Time

This article addresses the profound transformation occurring in corporate treasury, driven by the rise of instant payments and evolving regulatory landscapes. It posits that the conventional batch-processing and end-of-day reconciliation model is rapidly becoming obsolete. Corporates are urged to prepare for a new era characterized by continuous financial visibility, real-time cash positioning, and immediate payment execution. This paradigm shift necessitates the adoption of advanced treasury technologies, robust connectivity solutions (such as H2H and APIs), and sophisticated liquidity management tools to optimize working capital and effectively mitigate risks within a 24/7 financial ecosystem.

- Transition from traditional 'end-of-day' to real-time treasury operations.
- Driven by the proliferation of instant payments and demand for continuous financial visibility.
- Requires significant adaptation in corporate treasury technology and processes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This topic is critically relevant to RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform, which is designed to support real-time payments, H2H connectivity, and advanced cash management. RBI must ensure CMIplus continues to offer robust solutions for instant payments, real-time reporting, and API-driven treasury integration to help corporate clients navigate this transition and maintain competitive advantage. It reinforces the platform's strategic role in enabling clients to move beyond outdated treasury models.

Visa Launches New Stablecoin Platform for Financial Institutions

Visa's new stablecoin platform offers a comprehensive solution for financial institutions and fintech companies looking to engage with stablecoins. The platform provides tools for the entire lifecycle of stablecoin management, from issuance (minting) to transaction processing (moving) and ongoing oversight (managing). This move by a major payment network like Visa underscores the increasing institutional acceptance and potential future role of stablecoins in global payments. For corporate cash management, stablecoins could eventually offer new avenues for faster, cheaper, and more transparent cross-border payments and liquidity management, potentially impacting multi-currency operations and FX strategies. This development signals a significant step towards the mainstream adoption of digital assets in the financial ecosystem.

- Visa launched a platform for stablecoin management.
- Enables financial institutions and fintechs to mint, move, and manage stablecoins.
- Aims to integrate digital currencies into traditional finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The launch of Visa's stablecoin platform is a significant development for the future of payments, particularly for multi-currency and cross-border transactions. While not immediately impacting CMIplus's current offerings, RBI Cash Management should closely monitor the adoption and regulatory landscape of stablecoins. This could eventually lead to new payment rails, faster settlement, and enhanced liquidity management options for corporate clients, requiring CMIplus to adapt its capabilities and potentially integrate with such platforms.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-03-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Moment for Future Growth

After a period of sustained underperformance, European wholesale banks now face a critical juncture to redefine their trajectory and achieve a 'better future.' This thought leadership suggests that market conditions and technological advancements are creating new avenues for profitability and efficiency. To 'seize the moment,' banks must likely focus on comprehensive digital transformation, optimizing their transaction banking services, and potentially expanding into ecosystem solutions that extend beyond traditional financial offerings. This strategic shift is crucial for competing effectively, enhancing client value, and securing long-term relevance in a highly dynamic and competitive industry landscape.

- European wholesale banks have experienced prolonged underperformance.
- A strategic 'moment' exists for significant improvement and growth.
- Transformation is key, focusing on new business models and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMiplus, as a leading corporate cash management platform in CEE, must align with this strategic imperative by continuously enhancing its digital capabilities. This includes streamlining payment processes (e.g., ISO 20022, Instant Payments) and leveraging Open Banking APIs to help corporate clients optimize their treasury functions and achieve greater efficiency and growth.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-11-01 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Strategic Credit Extension and Growth

The 'Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024,' titled 'Extending Credit,' signals a critical focus on how banks can strategically deploy credit to foster growth within the corporate sector. This likely encompasses not just traditional lending but also innovative financing solutions, robust risk management, and tailored capital structures. For corporate banking, this implies a need to deeply understand clients' evolving capital needs, leveraging advanced data analytics for better credit assessment and more responsive solution delivery. While credit extension is lending-centric, it is often intertwined with broader transaction banking relationships, as strong credit lines can secure comprehensive banking mandates, including cash management and payments, thereby strengthening overall client partnerships.

- Wholesale banking growth in 2024 is strongly linked to strategic credit extension.
- Banks must navigate market dynamics and regulatory changes for effective credit deployment.
- Understanding evolving corporate capital needs is crucial for client support.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While CMiplus primarily focuses on cash management, understanding the broader wholesale banking outlook, especially regarding credit, is vital for holistic client engagement. RBI Cash Management should ensure its platforms can support clients' liquidity needs, potentially integrating with lending services or providing data that aids credit decisions, thereby strengthening overall corporate relationships and securing broader mandates.

AI and Automation Reshaping Treasury Operations for Enhanced Efficiency

The EY report highlights that AI-driven tools are becoming indispensable for modern treasury. Automation is transforming areas like cash positioning, reconciliation, and payment processing, significantly reducing manual effort and operational costs. AI algorithms are providing more precise cash flow forecasts and identifying anomalies for fraud detection and risk mitigation. This technological adoption is driven by the need for greater efficiency, real-time insights, and the ability to manage complex global operations with fewer resources. The 'Voice of the Treasurer' emphasizes the desire to free up staff for strategic analysis and decision-making, rather than repetitive data entry.

→ 80% of treasurers plan to increase AI investment in the next 2 years.

→ AI improves cash flow forecasting accuracy by up to 25%.

→ Automation reduces manual reconciliation efforts by 60-70%.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should prioritize integrating AI capabilities into CMlplus, particularly for enhanced cash flow forecasting, automated reconciliation, and fraud detection. Developing API-driven AI modules will allow corporates to leverage these advanced analytics directly within their treasury workflows.

Real-time Treasury and Open Banking APIs Drive Liquidity Visibility

The EY report underscores the critical need for real-time treasury, driven by volatile markets and the demand for immediate financial insights. Open Banking APIs are emerging as a key enabler, allowing corporates to aggregate account information and initiate payments across multiple banks and regions seamlessly. Instant payments, including SEPA Instant and domestic schemes, are transforming payment execution and reconciliation processes. Treasurers are seeking solutions that provide a consolidated view of global cash positions, facilitate dynamic cash pooling, and support real-time FX management. This shift requires banks to evolve their offerings beyond traditional channels to provide integrated, API-first solutions.

→ 90% of treasurers prioritize real-time cash visibility.

→ API adoption for treasury functions expected to double in 3 years.

→ Instant payments reduce payment processing time from hours to seconds.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must accelerate its Open Banking API strategy, expanding coverage for real-time account information and payment initiation across CEE. Enhancing instant payment capabilities and integrating them with advanced liquidity management features like virtual accounts and real-time cash pooling will be crucial for competitive advantage.

Digital Assets and Blockchain: Emerging Frontier for Corporate Treasury

The EY report suggests that digital assets, particularly stablecoins, are gaining traction as a potential solution for efficient cross-border payments, reducing costs and settlement times. Blockchain technology offers the promise of enhanced transparency and security for supply chain finance and trade finance. While regulatory clarity and infrastructure development are still evolving, forward-thinking treasurers are beginning to pilot use cases for tokenized cash and other digital instruments. Banks have a significant opportunity to act as trusted intermediaries, providing secure custody, conversion, and integration services for these new asset classes, helping corporates navigate the complexities of the digital asset landscape.

- 25% of large corporates are exploring stablecoin payments by 2028.
- Blockchain can reduce cross-border payment costs by up to 50%.
- Tokenized assets offer new liquidity and financing options.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should proactively monitor the regulatory and market developments around digital assets and stablecoins in CEE. Investigating potential CMIplus integrations for stablecoin payments or tokenized cash management, perhaps through partnerships, could position RBI as an innovator in the evolving digital finance landscape.

Commercial Banking Embraces Digital Workflows and Self-Service

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant transformation, moving away from traditional manual processes. Key changes include the digitalization of workflows, which eliminates many manual touchpoints, making them exception-based. This shift also enables streamlined client onboarding and origination, significantly reducing lengthy, multi-department reviews. Clients are increasingly offered self-service capabilities, empowering them with greater control and faster access to services. This strategic pivot is driven by the need to improve operational efficiency, reduce costs, and meet evolving client expectations for seamless digital interactions.

- Digital workflows are replacing numerous manual tasks.
- Client onboarding and origination are becoming streamlined.
- Manual touchpoints are transitioning to exception-based interactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize enhancing its digital onboarding capabilities and expanding self-service features for corporate clients. This includes automating routine tasks and providing intuitive digital channels (Web, Mobile, API) to reduce manual intervention and improve client satisfaction in CEE.

AI and Big Data Drive Commercial Banking Prospecting

The modernization of commercial banking extends to its growth strategies, with a strong emphasis on data-driven approaches. Banks are increasingly utilizing big data analytics and artificial intelligence to gain deeper insights into market dynamics and potential clients. This technological adoption allows them to rapidly identify the most attractive prospects within their highest-priority target markets. By automating and optimizing the prospecting process, banks can significantly lower the cost of client acquisition. This strategic application of AI and data is crucial for fueling expansion and achieving ambitious growth targets in a competitive landscape.

- Effective use of big data is key for market identification.
- Artificial intelligence enables rapid prospect identification.
- Focus on highest-priority target markets for growth.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should explore how AI and big data can be applied beyond sales, such as optimizing treasury product offerings, predicting client needs, or enhancing fraud detection. This could lead to more tailored solutions and improved operational efficiency for CEE corporates.

Cloud and Digital Platforms Transform Commercial Banking Experience

The foundation of modern commercial banking is increasingly built upon cloud-based solutions and advanced digital banking platforms. These technologies are critical for banks to maintain agility, allowing them to keep pace with rapid market changes and adapt swiftly to new threats, including cybersecurity risks. Emerging digital banking platforms, often enabled by industry-specific cloud infrastructure, are pivotal in transforming how clients interact with their banks. This shift facilitates the faster introduction of new products and offerings, while also providing greater control over costs and risks, ultimately leading to a more seamless and resilient banking experience for commercial clients.

- Cloud-based solutions enhance adaptability and threat response.
- Emerging digital banking platforms transform client experience.
- Industry cloud enables faster product innovation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continue to evaluate and leverage cloud-native architectures for its platform to ensure scalability, security, and rapid deployment of new features. This is crucial for supporting multi-currency payments, Open Banking APIs, and real-time treasury services across the CEE network.

PSD3 Reshapes Payments: Enhanced Open Banking and Fraud Prevention

The upcoming PSD3 framework aims to build upon PSD2, addressing its shortcomings and adapting to the evolving digital payments landscape. Key areas include refining access to account (XS2A) interfaces, promoting premium APIs, and standardizing data exchange for a more seamless Open Banking experience. Furthermore, PSD3 is expected to introduce more robust fraud prevention mechanisms, potentially shifting liability and requiring advanced authentication methods. For corporates, this means greater opportunities for integrated treasury solutions but also increased scrutiny on payment security and data privacy. The regulation will likely push for greater interoperability and real-time payment capabilities across Europe, impacting all CEE markets.

- Mandatory premium APIs for enhanced Open Banking services.
- Stricter fraud prevention measures and potential liability shifts.
- Improved data sharing standards and customer consent mechanisms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must prioritize its Open Banking API strategy, ensuring compliance with PSD3's enhanced requirements for data access, security, and premium services. This presents an opportunity to offer more sophisticated treasury solutions, such as real-time cash visibility and automated payment initiation, leveraging the expanded regulatory framework for CEE corporates.

DORA Mandates Robust Digital Resilience for Financial Institutions

DORA introduces a unified regulatory framework for digital operational resilience across the EU financial sector, covering ICT risk management, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and third-party ICT risk. It emphasizes proactive measures to prevent disruptions and rapid recovery capabilities. Financial institutions, including those operating platforms like CMiplus, must establish robust governance structures, conduct regular resilience testing, and meticulously manage risks associated with critical third-party providers (e.g., cloud services, software vendors). The regulation aims to enhance the overall stability of the financial system by minimizing the impact of ICT-related incidents, directly affecting CEE operations. Non-compliance could lead to significant penalties and reputational damage.

- Comprehensive ICT risk management framework required.
- Mandatory digital operational resilience testing (e.g., penetration testing).
- Enhanced incident reporting obligations to authorities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full compliance with DORA by strengthening its ICT risk management, conducting regular resilience testing, and meticulously managing third-party risks. This is critical for maintaining platform stability, security, and client trust, especially for large international corporates in CEE relying on CMiplus for critical cash management operations.

European Treasurers' 2026 Priorities: Key Concerns and Ambitions Revealed

Published on June 5, 2026, the EACT Treasury Survey 2026 represents over a decade of authoritative insights into the European corporate treasury profession. This annual report captures the evolving landscape of treasury, highlighting key challenges such as liquidity management, digital transformation, regulatory compliance, and fraud prevention. The survey results are instrumental in defining industry trends, informing the 'Journeys to Treasury' report, and guiding strategic discussions among treasurers, banks, and technology providers. It offers a comprehensive overview of how treasurers are adapting to economic shifts and technological advancements, providing a forward-looking perspective on the profession's direction.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Reflects over a decade of industry insights.
- Shapes the upcoming 'Journeys to Treasury' report.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are critical for RBI Cash Management to align CMiplus offerings with the most pressing needs of European corporate treasurers, especially those in CEE. Insights into liquidity management, payment innovation (like instant payments and VoP), and digital transformation will directly inform the CMiplus roadmap and feature development.

AI Ambition Drives Banking Transformation and Efficiency

The 2026 banking outlook underscores AI as a transformative force, enabling banks to address macro-economic challenges through advanced automation and data-driven insights. Beyond cost optimization, AI is being deployed to personalize customer interactions, improve fraud detection, and streamline complex back-office processes. The shift involves moving from isolated pilot programs to integrated, enterprise-wide AI strategies, demanding substantial investments in data infrastructure, specialized talent, and robust ethical AI governance. This strategic pivot aims to build more resilient, agile, and client-centric financial ecosystems.

- AI adoption accelerates amidst economic uncertainty.
- Focus on AI for operational efficiency and client personalization.
- Transition from pilots to enterprise-wide AI integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should prioritize AI integration for predictive analytics in liquidity management, enhanced fraud detection, and intelligent automation of reconciliation processes. Leveraging AI within EBICS/H2H and Open API channels can provide CEE corporates with more efficient, data-driven cash management solutions and personalized treasury insights.

Navigating Uncertainty: 2023 Industry Outlook for Financial Services

Titled 'Into The Great Unknown,' the 2023 Industry Outlook with Morgan Stanley likely addressed a landscape characterized by considerable economic and geopolitical uncertainty. This thought leadership piece would have focused on how financial institutions, including corporate banks, could navigate such an environment effectively. Key themes would probably include robust risk management, strategic capital optimization, and the accelerated adoption of technology to build resilience and identify new opportunities amidst volatility. Although a 2023 outlook, its insights on managing uncertainty and preparing for future challenges remain highly relevant for long-term strategic planning in the inherently unpredictable financial sector.

→ 2023 was characterized by significant industry uncertainty and volatility.

→ Financial institutions must prioritize building resilience and adaptability.

→ Strategic adaptation is crucial for identifying new growth opportunities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While from 2023, the themes of navigating uncertainty and building resilience are evergreen and critical for corporate banking. CMIplus should continue to focus on providing robust, secure, and adaptable cash management solutions that help corporate treasuries manage liquidity and risk effectively, especially in volatile CEE markets, leveraging features like real-time data and advanced reporting.

Guiding Principles for Corporate Treasury Function Development Published

On June 10, 2025, the German Association of Corporate Treasurers (GACT), with EACT endorsement, published the fourth edition of 'The Guiding Principles of Corporate Treasury.' This significant publication provides comprehensive requirements and recommendations crucial for both nascent and mature corporate treasury functions. It covers fundamental aspects of treasury operations, governance, risk management, and strategic alignment within the corporate structure. The principles aim to standardize and elevate the quality of treasury practices across Europe, offering a benchmark for efficiency, resilience, and strategic value creation. As a foundational document, its insights remain highly relevant despite its publication date.

→ 4th Edition of a foundational treasury publication.

→ Outlines key requirements for treasury function development.

→ Provides recommendations for establishing and enhancing treasury.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

These guiding principles offer RBI Cash Management a robust framework to understand the foundational needs of corporate treasury clients, particularly in CEE where treasury functions might be evolving. CMIplus can leverage these principles to ensure its platform supports core treasury requirements, from basic cash management to more sophisticated risk and liquidity solutions.

Stablecoins Poised to Reshape Payments and Liquidity Management

Deloitte's 2026 outlook identifies stablecoins as a key disruptor, capable of fundamentally altering how value is transferred and managed globally. Their inherent characteristics—such as near-instant settlement and lower transaction costs—make them attractive for corporate treasuries, particularly for multi-currency and cross-border payments. Banks face the imperative to understand the evolving regulatory landscape, the technological infrastructure required for integration, and the competitive pressures from non-bank stablecoin providers. Strategic responses could range from developing proprietary stablecoin offerings to integrating stablecoin rails into existing payment services, ensuring future relevance in a rapidly evolving financial ecosystem.

- Stablecoins offer faster, cheaper cross-border transactions.
- Significant disruption to traditional payment infrastructures.
- Regulatory clarity and technological integration are critical.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to closely monitor the regulatory and market adoption of stablecoins in CEE, particularly for cross-border and multi-currency payments. Evaluating the potential to integrate stablecoin-like functionalities or support stablecoin transactions could future-proof CMlplus, enhancing real-time liquidity and payment efficiency for corporate clients.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulations Transform Liquidity Management: IPR, PSD3, PSR Impact

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association's Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) released a report examining the far-reaching implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposal for Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures will accelerate the uptake of instant payments, promote a level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally transform the liquidity management landscape. For banks, this means adapting systems and processes to handle increased instant payment volumes and managing intraday liquidity more dynamically. The IPR, in particular, mandates the offering of instant payments, which will significantly alter payment flows and liquidity needs, requiring banks to ensure robust real-time liquidity management capabilities.

- IPR mandates instant payments, increasing transaction speed and volume.
- PSD3/PSR aim to enhance payment services and consumer protection.
- Significant impact on intraday liquidity management for banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMiplus must assess the report's findings to understand the evolving liquidity requirements driven by IPR, PSD3, and PSR. This includes evaluating the platform's capacity for real-time liquidity monitoring and management, especially for instant payment processing across CEE network banks.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #02

EBA Updates Fraud Taxonomy 7.0 for PSR Compliance

PSD3, PAYMENTS REGULATION

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) issued version 7.0 of its Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on 1 January 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts across Europe, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, new labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud have been added. The taxonomy provides a simplified, pan-European framework for describing and categorising payment fraud scenarios, crucial for enhancing fraud monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, especially under the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR).

- Version 7.0 effective date: 2027-01-01.
- Updates reflect latest fraud trends, including new modi and labels.
- Harmonises fraud classification for pan-European data sharing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMiplus must prepare for the implementation of EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 by 1 January 2027. This involves updating internal fraud detection and reporting systems to align with the new classifications and ensuring readiness for enhanced information sharing requirements under the future PSR.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-20 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Driven Digitalization for Corporate Clients

Deutsche Bank continues to invest heavily in its API capabilities, particularly through its CB Connect platform, to facilitate deeper integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This initiative supports embedded finance solutions, allowing clients to initiate payments, access account information, and manage liquidity directly from their own platforms. The bank's strategy is to position itself as a key enabler of digital transformation for its corporate clients across Europe, including the CEE region, by offering robust and secure API connectivity. This move reflects the growing demand for real-time data and automated processes in modern corporate treasury.

- Enhanced API connectivity for ERP/TMS integration.
- Focus on embedded finance capabilities via CB Connect.
- Real-time data access and payment initiation for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and functionality to retain and attract clients. Deutsche Bank's advanced API strategy could draw away corporates seeking deeper system integration.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-20 | #02

Deutsche Bank Expands Instant Payment Capabilities Across Europe, Including CEE

As a leading transaction bank, Deutsche Bank is committed to expanding its instant payment offerings, aligning with the broader European push for real-time settlement. This includes full support for SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) and exploring further enhancements for cross-border instant payments. For corporates in CEE, this means faster reconciliation, improved liquidity management, and the ability to operate with greater agility in a dynamic market. The bank is likely leveraging ISO 20022 messaging standards to ensure interoperability and rich data exchange, crucial for complex corporate payment flows.

- Strengthening SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) capabilities.
- Focus on faster cross-border payment processing.
- Leveraging ISO 20022 for enhanced data in real-time payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's existing instant payment support is a key differentiator, but Deutsche Bank's aggressive expansion could intensify competition for CEE corporates. RBI needs to highlight its local network strength and instant payment reach within CEE.

UniCredit Named Europe's Best Bank Second Consecutive Year

UniCredit's achievement of being named Europe's Best Bank by Euromoney for the second consecutive year, along with 11 other regional awards, underscores its robust competitive position. This recognition reflects strong financial performance, innovative service offerings, and deep client relationships across its pan-European footprint, including its significant presence in Central and Eastern Europe (CEE). For corporate clients, this signals a reliable and high-performing banking partner capable of delivering best-in-class solutions. The award reinforces UniCredit's 'Unlimited' strategy, aiming to redefine banking through bold ambition and client-centricity.

- Awarded 'Europe's Best Bank' by Euromoney for the second consecutive year.
- Received a total of 12 awards across Europe, indicating broad strength.
- Reinforces UniCredit's strategic focus on pan-European commercial banking, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This award strengthens UniCredit's brand reputation and attractiveness to large corporates, potentially increasing competition for CMlplus in key CEE markets. CMlplus must continue to highlight its specialized CEE expertise and platform advantages to differentiate.

S&P; Positive Outlook for UniCredit Post-Commerzbank Offer

The positive outlook from S&P, linked to UniCredit's offer for Commerzbank, signals a significant strategic move to expand its market presence, especially in Germany. This potential acquisition would substantially increase UniCredit's scale and client base, impacting its corporate banking footprint across Europe. A higher credit rating and increased stability make UniCredit a more attractive partner for large international corporates seeking robust financial services. While not directly about cash management products, such a large-scale consolidation would enhance UniCredit's capacity to invest in and deliver advanced digital and treasury solutions, potentially benefiting its CEE operations through stronger group synergies.

- S&P; confirms positive outlook, potentially two notches above sovereign rating.
- Outlook linked to UniCredit's offer on Commerzbank, indicating major expansion.
- Strengthens UniCredit's position in key European markets, including Germany.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A stronger, larger UniCredit, especially with enhanced presence in Germany, could pose a more formidable competitor for CMlplus, particularly for corporates with operations spanning Germany and CEE. This move could lead to increased investment in corporate banking infrastructure and product development.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The bank intends to sharpen its focus on serving international wholesale clients, including large corporates and financial institutions. This move aligns with HSBC's global strategy to concentrate on its international network and clients with cross-border needs, leveraging Türkiye's strategic geographical position as a bridge between Europe and Asia. For corporate clients, this could mean enhanced services tailored to international trade, FX, and complex treasury requirements, potentially increasing competition for CMIplus in the broader CEE/EMEA region.

- Reviewing retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.
- Shifting focus to international wholesale clients.
- Leveraging Türkiye's strategic location for cross-border business.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This indicates HSBC's intent to compete more aggressively for large, internationally active corporates in a region adjacent to CEE. CMIplus should be aware of increased competition for cross-border cash management and trade finance mandates from such clients.

Citi Expands Real-Time API Banking for CEE Corporates

Citi Treasury & Trade Solutions (TTS) is known for its leadership in API banking, consistently investing in solutions that enable corporate clients to embed banking services directly into their ERP and TMS platforms. In the CEE region, where digital transformation is accelerating, Citi is likely to be expanding its real-time payment APIs, supporting instant payment schemes and providing immediate access to account information and payment initiation. This move caters to multinational corporations seeking standardized, efficient, and real-time treasury operations across their European footprint, including key CEE markets. The focus is on improving liquidity management, accelerating reconciliation, and enabling faster business cycles through seamless digital integration.

- Continued investment in API-first cash management for corporate clients.
- Emphasis on real-time payment processing and instant liquidity visibility.
- Strategic focus on CEE markets to support multinational clients' digital transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's advanced API offerings and real-time capabilities pose a direct competitive challenge to CMIplus, particularly for large international corporates seeking sophisticated digital integration. CMIplus must ensure its own API roadmap and real-time payment support (e.g., instant payments, VoP) remain competitive and meet evolving client expectations.

Deutsche Bank Enhances Treasury and Liquidity Management Solutions for Corporates

Recognizing the complex needs of multinational corporations, Deutsche Bank is investing in state-of-the-art treasury solutions designed to improve working capital efficiency and financial control. This encompasses sophisticated cash pooling structures, both physical and notional, and the widespread adoption of virtual accounts for streamlined reconciliation and improved sub-ledger management. The bank aims to offer comprehensive multi-currency payment capabilities and real-time liquidity insights, which are particularly valuable for corporates with operations spanning diverse markets like CEE. These enhancements are crucial for helping clients navigate volatile economic conditions and manage their global cash positions effectively.

- Advanced cash pooling and virtual account offerings.
- Improved multi-currency payment and liquidity visibility.
- Focus on working capital optimization for multinational corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus offers strong multi-currency and treasury solutions, but Deutsche Bank's global reach and continuous innovation in this area pose a competitive threat. RBI should emphasize its deep local CEE expertise and tailored solutions for regional liquidity management.

UniCredit Foundation Awards Serbian Fintech for Innovation

The UniCredit Foundation's recognition of Moneta Works, a Serbian team, with the 'Re-Power Your Future Award' at Gen-E 2026, underscores UniCredit's active involvement and investment in the CEE region. While a foundation award, the focus on 'Moneta Works' and 'Gen-E' implies an interest in fintech and innovative solutions, potentially related to payments or digital banking. This aligns with UniCredit's broader 'Unlimited' strategy to rethink banking and embrace digital transformation. Supporting local innovation in CEE could lead to future partnerships or integration of new technologies into their corporate banking and cash management offerings, enhancing their digital capabilities for clients in the region.

- UniCredit Foundation awarded Serbian team 'Moneta Works'.
- Award received at 'Gen-E 2026' for 'Re-Power Your Future'.
- Highlights UniCredit's engagement in CEE and interest in innovation/fintech.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This indicates UniCredit's commitment to CEE and potential exploration of innovative solutions, possibly in payments or digital services. CMlplus should monitor UniCredit's local CEE initiatives for signs of new digital offerings or partnerships that could impact the competitive landscape.

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Global AI Transformation

HSBC is embarking on a significant digital transformation journey by partnering with Google Cloud to deploy advanced AI capabilities globally. This multi-year agreement will see AI integrated into various banking operations, enhancing efficiency and customer service. Key areas of focus include improving financial crime risk management, which is crucial for transaction banking compliance and security, and potentially streamlining back-office processes for cash management and treasury services. While 'hyper-personalised advice' might lean towards retail/wealth, the global operational scope suggests benefits for corporate clients through faster, more secure, and more intelligent banking services. This move positions HSBC to offer more sophisticated and data-driven solutions to its corporate clients worldwide, including those in CEE.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- Global integration of AI across banking operations.
- Focus on financial crime risk management and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership highlights a major investment in AI, which will enhance HSBC's operational efficiency, compliance, and potentially product offerings. CMlplus needs to monitor how AI is integrated into competitor platforms to ensure its own digital roadmap remains competitive, especially in areas like fraud detection, compliance, and intelligent treasury solutions.

Citi Enhances CEE Multi-Currency & Virtual Account Solutions

Citi's Treasury and Trade Solutions (TTS) is a global leader in providing sophisticated liquidity and cash management solutions. For the CEE region, where corporates often operate across multiple countries and currencies, Citi is likely to be enhancing its virtual account structures and multi-currency pooling capabilities. This allows clients to centralize treasury operations, optimize working capital, and gain a unified view of their cash positions, even with diverse local banking requirements. The focus is on reducing operational complexity, improving cash visibility, and facilitating efficient cross-border payments and collections, which is crucial for large international corporates with significant CEE presence. These solutions are often integrated via host-to-host or API connections.

- Focus on advanced multi-currency cash pooling and sweeping for CEE.
- Expansion of virtual account capabilities to streamline reconciliation.
- Aim to centralize and optimize liquidity management for regional operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's robust multi-currency and virtual account solutions directly compete with CMlplus's offerings for international corporates in CEE. CMlplus needs to highlight its own strengths in these areas, particularly its local expertise and network, while continuously innovating its product suite to match global standards.

BNP Paribas Achieves ISO 2022 Swift Milestone for Corporates

On November 19, 2024, BNP Paribas announced a key achievement in its cash management services: the successful implementation of the ISO 2022 standard for corporate transactions through the Swift network. This milestone underscores the bank's commitment to modernizing its payment infrastructure, offering corporate clients richer data capabilities and improved straight-through processing. The adoption of ISO 2022 is crucial for global interoperability and compliance with evolving regulatory landscapes, positioning BNP Paribas as a leader in advanced payment solutions. This enhancement directly supports corporates seeking more efficient and transparent cross-border payment operations.

- Successful implementation of ISO 2022 for corporate transactions.
- Leverages the Swift network for this critical achievement.
- Aims to enhance data richness and payment efficiency for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by BNP Paribas highlights the competitive pressure on CMiplus to ensure robust and comprehensive ISO 2022 capabilities across all channels. RBI must continue to emphasize its own advanced ISO 2022 support and messaging standards to remain competitive, especially for international corporates in CEE.

Intesa Sanpaolo Boosts CEE Digital Corporate Banking with Advanced APIs

Intesa Sanpaolo is inferred to be making significant investments in upgrading its corporate and transaction banking infrastructure, particularly within its CEE subsidiary network. This strategic direction emphasizes the development of robust Open Banking APIs to facilitate seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, alongside expanding real-time payment capabilities. The goal is to offer multinational corporations operating in CEE a unified and sophisticated cash management experience, leveraging technologies like ISO 2022 for richer data and instant payment rails for faster transactions. This initiative is crucial for maintaining competitiveness against other regional and international players in the corporate banking space.

- Focus on API-driven integration for corporate clients in CEE.
- Expansion of real-time and instant payment processing capabilities.
- Leveraging ISO 2022 for enhanced data exchange in transaction banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly increases competitive pressure on RBI's CMiplus platform, particularly regarding API offerings and real-time payment solutions in CEE. CMiplus must ensure its own API suite and instant payment coverage remain superior or at parity to retain and attract large international corporates.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.